Meeting Coach Scoring Guide

Seven sections · 24 criteria · Adviser communication

Prepared for consultant review on 2 October 2026

This guide explains what Meeting Coach assesses, how evidence supports a judgment, and how the resulting scores are calculated. Please review whether the criteria and anchors are fair, observable and useful across different meeting types.

The tool assesses the adviser's communication and meeting craft. It does not judge clients, evaluate investment suitability, certify compliance or generate client advice. English, Afrikaans and mixed-language meetings use the same criteria; coaching is in British English and quotes retain the original speech.

The seven sections

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How to read each section

Each section has its own page with the current anchors and exact criterion wording. Explanations, evidence guidance and not-assessable examples are interpretation notes for consultant review; they do not add new scoring rules.

What a criterion verdict means

Verdict	Meaning
Met	The relevant behaviour is demonstrated by the cited interaction.
Partially met	The behaviour is incomplete, inconsistent or only partly demonstrated.
Not met	A real opportunity arose and was missed or contradicted; the relevant interaction must be cited.
Not assessable	No relevant opportunity or adequate evidence is visible. This is not a failure.

The Afrikaans-specific Plain language criterion has been removed. All seven sections remain; Plain language now has two criteria. This is the operative rubric, version 1.1.

How scoring is determined

The computer calculates conversation metrics. The AI makes evidence-based judgments against the rubric. The server validates the output and calculates the overall; it does not determine whether the AI's interpretation is fair.

From transcript to category score

1 Confirm context

Select the adviser and confirm other speakers as clients or observers. Both voices applies only to a confirmed couple with two clients. Unsupported attribution is rejected.

2 Calculate the metrics

Code calculates the figures below. Observer speech remains in context but is excluded from adviser/client metrics; it still breaks uninterrupted spans.

3 Assess every criterion

Each verdict has a rationale. An assessable criterion requires a verbatim quote from a transcript segment; that segment supplies its speaker and any real timestamp.

4 Apply the category anchors

The AI assigns each assessable category a value from 1 to 5 against the low, middle and high anchors. Middle means ordinary competence. Repeated strong evidence supports the top; clear counter-evidence supports the bottom.

5 Validate and average

Section and criterion IDs must be complete and unique. Unassessable sections have no numeric value. The server calculates the equal-weight mean of assessable sections.

There is no fixed conversion from criterion verdicts to points, no arithmetic average of the criteria, and no special weighting for sections with more criteria. Values 2 and 4, or decimals, are model judgments between the supplied anchors; all five levels are not separately defined in the current rubric.

What the calculated metrics mean

Metric	Calculation and limitation
Talk share	Estimated adviser duration ÷ (adviser + client duration). Use timestamp gaps when all starts are valid and non-decreasing; otherwise words at 140 words per minute.
Question turns	Adviser speech segments ending in a question mark. Not a comprehensive linguistic inventory.
Uninterrupted spans	Consecutive segments by the same speaker. Observer speech breaks a run. Gaps include pauses; repeated starts and an unknown final tail use word estimates.
Duration	Known total if supplied; otherwise the visible timestamp span plus estimated tail, or a word-based estimate. Known duration never creates quote timestamps.
Client balance	For a couple only: larger client speaking duration ÷ smaller. Approximate 2:1 and 3:1 thresholds guide judgment; they do not measure understanding.

The overall score

Example: six assessable category scores of 4, 3, 3, 4, 4 and 3 sum to 21. Both voices is n/a in a solo meeting. Overall = 21 ÷ 6 = 3.50 out of 5. A fully unassessable review has overall n/a. Displayed precision is not proof of scientific accuracy.

A valid quote does not prove a fair interpretation. Scores can vary between AI runs. Calibration should check evidence coverage, fair n/a decisions, useful coaching and agreement with human judgments.

1 Human before agenda

Assess whether the opening recognises the person and lets the client influence the conversation before financial analysis begins.

Current scoring anchors

Anchor	Current rubric wording
Low	Numbers within the first minute, no check-in.
Middle	Brief check-in, then adviser-set agenda.
High	Genuine opening conversation, and the client shaped the agenda.

Judge the quality of engagement, not the length of small talk. A polite opening alone supports the middle anchor; strong evidence combines a meaningful response with a client-shaped agenda.

1.1 Engage with the opening answer

The adviser opened by asking how the client is doing, and engaged with the answer rather than treating it as a formality.

A check-in matters when the adviser listens to the reply and follows its meaning. A scripted question followed immediately by figures is weaker evidence.

Evidence to look for: Look for the opening question, the client's answer and the adviser's response together.

Not assessable when: The recording or excerpt omits the opening.

1.2 Acknowledge life events

Life events mentioned by the client were acknowledged before moving to financials.

Recognise a change, loss, milestone or pressure before moving to its financial implications. The criterion assesses acknowledgement rather than counselling skill.

Evidence to look for: A specific acknowledgement of the event and what it means to the client.

Not assessable when: No life event is mentioned or visible.

1.3 Let the client shape the agenda

The client was asked what would make the meeting most useful to them, and the agenda reflected the answer.

Ask what would make the meeting useful and visibly adapt the order or priorities. Asking the question without responding to the answer is only partial evidence.

Evidence to look for: The invitation, the client's priority and the agreed agenda or next transition.

Not assessable when: The relevant opening or agenda discussion is missing.

Point for consultant review

A transcript starting after the opening cannot establish how the meeting began. Consider whether the opening is visible before assigning a score.

2 Listening share

Assess whether the adviser makes room for the client and responds to what the client actually says. Speaking share supports this judgment but does not define listening quality by itself.

Current scoring anchors

Anchor	Current rubric wording
Low	Adviser talk share 65% or more, or a monologue over 4 minutes.
Middle	Share 45-65%.
High	Share 45% or below, with reflections and follow-ups that build on the client's own words.

The current anchors use 45% and 65% adviser-share reference points and a four-minute monologue. These are rubric thresholds, not proven universal cut-offs. Reflections and responsive follow-ups are also needed for a high judgment.

2.1 Leave room for the client

Per the computed metrics, the adviser spoke less than the client (or close to parity).

Use the computed adviser share of adviser/client speech. Observers are excluded. Compare the figure with the interaction; the model must not invent a different percentage.

Evidence to look for: The provided share, plus a real exchange illustrating how space was given or taken.

Not assessable when: Reliable adviser/client attribution is unavailable.

2.2 Build questions on the answer

The adviser's questions built on what the client had just said, rather than returning to a script.

Follow up a concern, goal or detail the client has just introduced. A question can be open-ended yet still ignore the preceding answer.

Evidence to look for: Adjacent turns showing a clear connection between the client's words and the follow-up.

Not assessable when: No relevant question-and-answer exchange is visible.

2.3 Reflect meaning and feeling

The adviser used reflective listening - restating the client's meaning or feeling before responding - not only questions.

Restate or check the client's meaning before responding. Repeating words mechanically is weaker than accurately reflecting the concern or feeling behind them.

Evidence to look for: A client statement followed by a reflection and, where available, confirmation or correction.

Not assessable when: The excerpt offers no assessable opportunity for a reflection.

2.4 Check during explanations

Long explanations were broken with checks rather than delivered as monologues.

Break substantial explanations with a useful invitation to respond. A token check after a very long speech may support only partial achievement.

Evidence to look for: An explanation and the check that lets the client ask, correct or respond.

Not assessable when: No substantial explanation occurs in the visible passage.

Point for consultant review

Review the overlapping anchor boundaries at exactly 45% and 65%, and whether the thresholds suit different meeting types. Planned technical explanations can increase adviser share without establishing poor listening.

3 Behavioural coaching moments

Assess how the adviser responds to worry and helps the client think ahead about difficult periods. This measures communication and preparation, not the correctness of investment advice.

Current scoring anchors

Anchor	Current rubric wording
Low	Client anxiety met with a prediction or brushed past; no forward-looking coaching.
Middle	Reassurance given, plan referenced.
High	Anxiety named before it was answered AND future turbulence rehearsed unprompted.

A strong judgment needs both recognition of anxiety and forward-looking preparation when relevant. Missing anxiety or market discussion is not automatically failure; first establish the opportunity.

3.1 Name the concern before answering

When the client expressed worry, the adviser named the concern before answering it.

Acknowledge the worry in the client's terms before reassuring or explaining. Immediate predictions or dismissal can be counter-evidence when the client expressed a clear concern.

Evidence to look for: The client's worry and the response that names, checks or bypasses it.

Not assessable when: No worry or relevant concern is expressed.

3.2 Anchor reassurance to the plan

Reassurance was anchored to the client's plan and long-term evidence, not to predictions about markets, tax, or politics.

Explain reassurance through the client's plan and relevant long-term evidence. Confident forecasts about markets, tax or politics do not satisfy this communication criterion.

Evidence to look for: A reassurance exchange and the stated reason supporting it.

Not assessable when: No reassurance is offered or called for.

3.3 Separate controllable factors

The adviser separated what is controllable from what is not, out loud.

Make the distinction aloud between choices the client can influence and external events they cannot. The link should help the client decide where to focus.

Evidence to look for: An explicit contrast between controllable actions and uncertain external conditions.

Not assessable when: No relevant uncertainty or decision context appears.

3.4 Rehearse a future difficult period

Proactive inoculation: at some point the adviser rehearsed a future bad patch before it exists, rather than only reacting to raised fears.

Prepare for a possible bad patch before it happens, rather than responding only to a fear already raised. Assess the communication exercise, not a proposed financial strategy.

Evidence to look for: A prospective scenario and discussion of how the client would respond or use the plan.

Not assessable when: No relevant opportunity for future-turbulence preparation is established.

Point for consultant review

The high anchor combines reactive and proactive behaviours. Review whether the requirement is appropriate for every type of meeting before changing it.

4 Plain language

Assess whether explanations are understandable and whether the adviser checks actual understanding. Plain language concerns communication, not a client's education, intelligence or financial knowledge.

Current scoring anchors

Anchor	Current rubric wording
Low	Jargon used repeatedly without translation.
Middle	Mostly plain, occasional unexplained terms.
High	Every technical term translated at first use, and understanding tested by invitation, not assumption.

Frequent unexplained jargon supports the low anchor. Mostly clear speech supports the middle. Strong evidence pairs ordinary explanations with an invitation to explain the idea back. A polite yes alone does not prove understanding.

4.1 Explain terms at first use

Technical terms were either avoided or explained in ordinary words at first use.

Avoid unnecessary technical terms or explain them when first introduced. Clear explanations should retain the meaning rather than replacing precision with a misleading simplification.

Evidence to look for: The first use of a term and the nearby explanation or ordinary-language alternative. Repeated unexplained terms can be counter-evidence.

Not assessable when: No relevant term or explanation is visible; do not invent a terminology problem.

4.2 Invite teach-back

Understanding was checked by inviting the client to say it back in their own words - teach-back, not just "does that make sense?".

Invite the client to explain the idea in their own words so misunderstandings can surface. Frame the invitation as a check on the explanation, not a test of the client.

Evidence to look for: An invitation such as asking how the client would describe the idea, followed by their response and any clarification.

Not assessable when: No substantive explanation or suitable understanding-check opportunity occurs.

Point for consultant review

The language-specific subsection has been removed. This section now has two criteria; the category keeps the same equal weight as the other assessable categories.

5 Agreements and adherence

Assess whether a meeting turns discussion into understood decisions and manageable next steps. A transcript can show how follow-through was supported; it cannot prove that actions were later completed.

Current scoring anchors

Anchor	Current rubric wording
Low	Meeting ends without decisions restated.
Middle	Adviser summarises actions.
High	Readback confirmed aloud, action load kept small, first step easy, obstacles anticipated.

An adviser-only summary supports the middle anchor. Stronger evidence includes client confirmation, explicit ownership and timing, a manageable first step and anticipated obstacles. No decision is not automatically a poor close.

5.1 Read back and confirm decisions

Every decision reached was restated by the adviser in one sentence, and the client audibly confirmed each.

Restate each decision clearly and invite audible confirmation. A general closing thank-you is not evidence that every material decision was understood and agreed.

Evidence to look for: The decision readback and the client's confirmation or correction.

Not assessable when: No decision was reached or the decision/close is outside the excerpt.

5.2 Assign actions and timing

Next steps were assigned out loud - what the adviser does, what the client does, and roughly by when.

Say who will do what and roughly when. Separate adviser responsibilities from client tasks so ownership does not remain implied.

Evidence to look for: Explicit action, owner and approximate deadline stated aloud.

Not assessable when: There are no relevant next steps in the visible meeting.

5.3 Keep the action load manageable

The client's action load was kept deliberately small (roughly three items or fewer), with the first step easy and near-term.

The rubric favours roughly three client tasks or fewer, with an easy, near-term first step. Count actions from the conversation rather than assuming brevity means feasibility.

Evidence to look for: The requested task set and a practical first action the client can begin.

Not assessable when: No client action is assigned.

5.4 Anticipate obstacles

Likely obstacles to follow-through were asked about or anticipated ("what would get in the way of this?").

Ask about or anticipate what could prevent follow-through. A relevant practical obstacle matters more than a generic encouragement to get things done.

Evidence to look for: A question about barriers or a specific barrier addressed before the meeting ends.

Not assessable when: No follow-through commitment or relevant opportunity is present.

Point for consultant review

Keep the distinction between communication of agreement and actual adherence. This category does not certify informed consent, compliance or financial suitability.

6 Anchored to their why

Assess whether the adviser connects discussion and recommendations to what this particular client values and wants. The category measures the expressed link, not whether a recommendation is financially suitable.

Current scoring anchors

Anchor	Current rubric wording
Low	Recommendations justified only by product or tax logic.
Middle	Goals mentioned generically.
High	Each material recommendation explicitly tied back to something this client said they want.

Product, tax or return logic alone supports the low anchor when personal goals were relevant. A generic reference to goals is middle evidence. Strong evidence ties each material recommendation to a stated client priority.

6.1 Link recommendations to stated goals

Recommendations were linked out loud to the client's own stated goals, values, or life plans ("because you said you want X..."), not only to returns, tax, or product features.

Explain aloud why a recommendation relates to a goal, value or life plan the client has expressed. Merely mentioning goals beside product features is weaker evidence.

Evidence to look for: The client-stated priority and the explicit recommendation-to-goal link, quoted separately if they occur in different segments.

Not assessable when: No material recommendation or relevant client priority is visible.

6.2 Use the client's own words

The client's own words for what matters were used, not the adviser's substitutes.

Use the client's terms for what matters instead of substituting the adviser's interpretation. A faithful reflection is stronger than a generic phrase such as financial freedom.

Evidence to look for: The original wording and its accurate use in the adviser's response.

Not assessable when: The client's relevant wording is absent from the excerpt.

6.3 Surface changes before advising

Where a goal had shifted, the shift was surfaced before advice was given on it.

If a goal has changed, recognise and clarify that change before advising on it. Do not assume previous goals remain current merely because a plan already exists.

Evidence to look for: The changed priority, its clarification and the sequence before the recommendation.

Not assessable when: No changed goal is raised or established.

Point for consultant review

A convincing connection needs both sides: the client's stated priority and the adviser's link to it. Do not infer goals from demographic details or invent a recommendation in a discussion-only meeting.

7 Both voices

Assess whether both partners in an explicitly confirmed couple meeting participate and confirm important decisions. Two non-adviser speakers do not establish a couple; assistants and observers are separate roles.

Current scoring anchors

Anchor	Current rubric wording
Low	One client near-silent and never drawn in.
Middle	Both spoke, but one clearly carried it.
High	Shares within roughly 2:1, quieter partner directly invited, and each confirmed decisions individually.

The rubric uses worse than about 3:1 as a concern and better than about 2:1 as support for a high score. Balanced time alone is insufficient: invitations, individual goals and confirmations also matter.

7.1 Balance client participation

Per the computed metrics, speaking time between the two clients was reasonably balanced (worse than ~3:1 should pull down; better than ~2:1 supports a high score).

Use the computed ratio of the larger to smaller client speaking time. Observer speech is excluded. A ratio reflects estimated participation, not equal understanding or an obligation to split time exactly.

Evidence to look for: The supplied ratio and a relevant exchange showing the participation pattern.

Not assessable when: Not a couple meeting or reliable separate client attribution is unavailable.

7.2 Invite the quieter partner directly

The quieter partner was directly invited in by name at least twice, including on at least one substantive decision.

The current criterion asks for at least two invitations by name, including one on a substantive decision. A single invitation can be partial evidence; absence needs an established opportunity.

Evidence to look for: The direct invitations, whom they addressed and whether one concerned a material decision.

Not assessable when: No relevant opportunity or decision is visible; the meeting is outside couple scope.

7.3 Explore goals individually

Goals questions were put to each partner individually, not only to the couple jointly.

Ask each partner about goals rather than accepting a joint answer as both people's priorities. Individual answers can reveal differences that a shared agenda masks.

Evidence to look for: A goals question addressed to each person and their separate responses.

Not assessable when: No goals discussion is visible or this is not a couple meeting.

7.4 Hear confirmation from both

Each decision was confirmed aloud by both, not by one on behalf of two.

Seek each partner's audible confirmation of each decision. One person's agreement on behalf of both is weaker evidence when a shared decision has actually been reached.

Evidence to look for: The decision and separate confirmations or corrections from both clients.

Not assessable when: No decision is reached or this is not a couple meeting.

Point for consultant review

Outside couple scope, the entire category is n/a and excluded from the overall. Within a couple meeting, distinguish a genuinely missed invitation from a passage too short to show the opportunity.